has already been cited for the Hindu Kush fortifications; for additional bibliography see also Ball 2019: Nos. 189, 239, 286, 398, 489, 845, 862, 1021, 1039, 2045, 2046, 2141.

62. See Lee (2006: 229 and *passim*) for a "Ghurid" dating of the ruins, and Baker and Allchin (1991: esp. 99) for the centuries-long use of decorative iconographies. The mural paintings from the western Bamiyan area were not unique of course, but conceivably an extension of the lavish painted programs in numerous grottoes and structures in Bamiyan and throughout the region's other principal valleys, particularly abundant in Funduqistan, Foladi, and Kakrak. Indeed, the common curved striations in these paintings (Figure 3.18) immediately evoke the nimbuses frequently seen behind the Buddha's head: e.g., Klimburg-Salter 2008: pl. V, det. 3. Cf. also Klimburg-Salter 1989: e.g., pls. XVIII, XXIII, XXIV fig. 26, LXXX fig. 103, and LXXXIV–LXXXVI. The eighth–ninth-century caves in Jaghuri (west of Ghazna) likely also had some paintings, though their unfinished (at Tapa Zaytun) or extremely eroded states make it difficult to identify traces. Cf. Verardi and Paparatti 2004: 104 and pl. XLVIIa–c. See Chapter 2 for Herberg's (e.g., 1982) documentation of traces of interior mural painting within Ghur's architectural remains. Pre-Islamic architectural cultures throughout the vast central span of Afghanistan, then, included painted programs.
63. Lee (2006: 238–241) also mentioned painted scenes from *Shah-nama* documented in 2002 at Chehel Burj (one of the farther western complexes, also visited by Maricq and Wiet [1959]); unfortunately, the paintings disappeared shortly afterward, probably looted and offered for sale at clandestine markets in Pakistan or Iran. See also Thomas 2018: app. 3; Ball 2019: No. 189; Ball, Bordeaux et al. 2019: 399.
64. Le Berre 1970: 45 (my trans.); also Fischer 1978: 351–352; W. Ball, pers. comm., April 2018; Ball 2019: No. 109; Ball 2020; Ball, however, considers Danestama's "interpretation as a *madrasa* [i.e., newly built] … a convincing one." The mosque known as Darra-i-Sheikh at Gorzivan (Faryab Province) presents a parallel to Danestama: also quadrangular in plan with circular corner towers, and a more complete *mihrab* with stucco revetment and remains of painted decoration. The additional surviving fragments of a floriated Kufic inscription of Darra-i-Sheikh led to its tentative dating in the later twelfth century, based on comparisons with inscriptions from Sar-i Pul (historical Anbir) and the *minar* of Jam-Firuzkuh. Cf. Bivar 1966; esp. Pinder-Wilson 1980: 97–98; Ball and Fischer 2019: 487; Ball 2019: No. 248; and Chapter 2. However, it is conceivable that Darra-i-Sheikh's *mihrab* was also a later addition to the structure, as proposed here for Danestama (see following in main text).
65. Le Berre (1970: 50) himself confessed to the collection of "only those ceramic fragments that appeared most interesting to us and unpainted pottery was not retained" (my trans.). Baker and Allchin's (1991: 195–196) subsequent exploration of Danestama resulted in the identification of pottery fragments and the extant vaulting as comparable to those from Shahr-i Zuhak, *c.* 500 CE. A prime example of the four-*ivan* Central Asian Buddhist monastery would be Ajina Tepe (cf. Litvinsky [1984] 2011), and within Afghanistan the recently excavated